



Android TV milestone

YouTube is reaching 50 million installs on Android TV, probably helped by the fact that it is pre-installed. <https://dgit.in/jun20-108>



The Huawei GT2

Huawei has released the GT2, a smartwatch with a battery life that lasts for a fortnight. <https://dgit.in/jun20-109>

FEATURE

components. Wiping this partition will just clear the built up cache and the device will simply go back to rebuilding it as you continue using it. Clearing cache also frees up some space in your device and can also fix certain issues at times.

- **/misc** – This partition contains all the miscellaneous system settings, usually on/off switches. The settings may include carrier or region ID, USB configuration and certain hardware settings. This partition is very important since it can cause several device features to malfunction if the partition becomes corrupt or goes missing. A missing /misc partition can also cause the Android device to not boot at all.

- **/sdcard** – This partition is the space that is available to users to store their files and data. Depending on your device, you could even have more than one sdcard partition. If your device has an external SD card slot, then the /sdcard partition refers to the internal storage device and the external SD card will be assigned a different partition – either a new partition called /sdcard2 or a separate directory within the /sdcard partition itself such as /sdcard/sd. Wiping the partition with the external SD card storage is completely safe, as long as you have backed up any important data or documents you may have on it. Wiping the /sdcard partition, however, results in wiping some system and app data and settings, but it still doesn't hinder the system's boot process or functionality.

- **/sd-ext** – This is an additional partition of the sdcard partition which is only present on some devices, typically ones that have custom ROMs or mods on them. It can usually be used with certain ROMs that have special features such as APP2SD+ or data2ext enabled. This is essentially a /data partition of the /sdcard, and stores some user data and settings that are typically stored on the /data partition. This is useful for devices with limited internal memory.

Without rooting your device, Android users typically can only access the data partition. The contents of this partition is what you will see in most file managers or when you connect it to a PC. If you have an external SD card

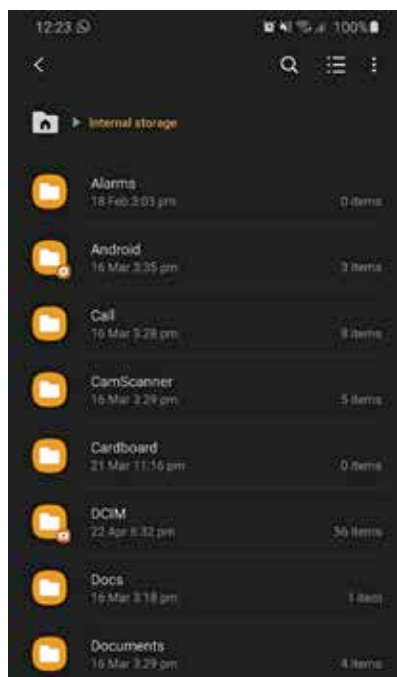
attached to the device, you will also be able to view the contents of it in this user accessible data partition. If your phone doesn't come packing a decent file explorer or manager, you can simply install one of the powerful third party ones available on the Play Store. You can also browse your data files on PC via USB connection, however, ensure that your phone is in MTP (Media Transfer) or File Transfer mode.

Android also divides its storage into three distinct categories which is quite different from a PC's file system layout. Here is how it divides its storage:

- **Device storage** – This refers to the pool of storage you can work with and access. You can even modify files in this storage area.

- **Portable SD card storage** – This storage area is allocated to external SD cards. You can load files into this and then insert it into your device.

- **Device root storage** – Every Android device has a special file system where all the root files are stored. This includes operating system files, sensitive application data, system apps, and more. Users typically cannot modify this file system for security and device safety reasons, unless, of course, they have root access.



File managers typically only show the contents of the /data partition

In the most basic sense, 'root' refers to the topmost folder in the Android file system. This would be the equivalent of the C:\ drive on Windows. Unlike Windows though, Android has built an invisible barrier about halfway up the file system tree and only allows you to access certain files before you hit this virtual wall, beyond which the root files lie. This is to stop users from making irreversible or irreparable changes to critical OS files.

HOW TO ACCESS THE ROOT FILES

If you have confidence in your software tweaking skills and want to access system-level files, you will have to gain 'root access' to modify these files. For that, you will need to do something probably everyone has heard of – root your device. Once you root your device and gain access to root files, there's no stopping the amount of tweaks you can apply to your phone. From deleting bloatware and unnecessary system apps to completely overhauling your device's system UI. You can overclock, underclock, partition SD card memory and change it into internal memory, install custom ROMs, mods, and much much more. You can even install an array of root apps which are capable of extraordinary functions such as blocking all ads in every single app, hibernating background apps, installing a custom recovery to flash ZIPs and create backups, and more. To access these root files on your rooted device, you will need file managers compatible with rooted devices. Some popular examples include Root File Manager, Root Browser, Solid Explorer File Manager, File Expert, and Root Explorer.

However, there is a way you can uninstall some bloatware apps without rooting your device. These apps would not typically be accessible to users without root but by using adb commands, you can actually uninstall bloatware without having to root. If you're spooked by the idea of rooting, this could be useful for you since most users want to root primarily to eliminate annoying system apps and other bloatware. **4**